

course/prep

cuisine/japanese

diet/vegan

form/staple

main/rice

Sushi Rice

Yield: ~350 g seasoned rice (2 servings) · Active 15 min · Total 45–60 min

On the total time: it swings with your cooking method — a rice cooker's soak and rest cycle runs longer than a stovetop pot.

Ingredients

Ingredient	Amount
Short grain rice	150 g
Rice vinegar	40 ml
Sugar	8 g
Salt	2 g

A note on rice variety: Akitakomachi is a good choice here — it's a Japanese short-grain cultivar bred from Koshihikari, developed in Akita Prefecture. Compared to Koshihikari, it's less sticky with more distinct, defined grains and a milder, cleaner flavour, which lets the vinegar seasoning come through rather than competing with the rice's own sweetness. Its firmer texture also holds up well once cooled, making it well suited to sushi.

Instructions

- 1. Rinse the rice.** Wash the short grain rice under cold water, swirling gently, until the water runs mostly clear. Drain well.
- 2. Cook the rice.** Cook using your preferred method (rice cooker or stovetop) with the appropriate water ratio for short grain rice. Let it rest, covered, for about 10 minutes after cooking.
- 3. Make the seasoning.** While the rice cooks, combine the vinegar, sugar, and salt in a small bowl. Stir until the sugar and salt fully dissolve (a few seconds in the microwave or a light warm-through on the stove helps if needed).
- 4. Mix the rice.** Transfer the hot cooked rice to a wide, shallow bowl (a *hangiri* or similar non-reactive dish works well). Pour the vinegar mixture evenly over the rice.
- 5. Fold, don't stir.** Using a rice paddle or spatula, cut and fold the seasoning into the rice with slicing motions, turning the rice over rather than mashing it, to coat the grains evenly without crushing them.

6. **Cool while fanning.** Fan the rice as you fold (or use a hand fan/piece of cardboard) to help it cool quickly and develop a glossy sheen. This also helps excess moisture evaporate.
7. **Rest.** Cover with a damp cloth and use the rice once it's cooled to roughly room temperature.